

# KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 31

## --"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

### I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

### II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

### III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

## **BIBLE TEACHING**

Last week we learned that there are two levels of karis cause and effect. When we choose to live on the first level of karis, we actively lay the foundation of orientation, and as a result we reap a more peaceful and stable life.

The second level of karis is more mysterious and requires more trust because the results cannot be predicted. This level is the most exciting, and those who live here love being with people who are training hard to live at this level. At the second level of karis, we simply trust God to marvelously respond as we plant our seeds of giving and service. We plant the seeds, but we do not know how those seeds grow, nor do we try to know. We simply rest, wait, and watch what happens.

In the Book of Proverbs, God teaches us how to determine where to sow our karis gifts. For our own protection and benefit, He encourages us to sow into the lives of the wise and avoid sowing into the lives of fools. Here are a few ways to spot the fools and the wise.

### **1. Fools refuse to be corrected or taught**

**Proverbs 1:7** *"The fear of the Lord is the beginning of knowledge; fools despise wisdom and instruction."*

The first characteristic of fools is their resistance to correction or instruction. So, if you see people resisting instruction or wisdom, you know that they are poor soil for investing your resources. If they are less interested in personal growth than they are in playing, apologizing, or defending themselves, they are probably fools. They may like instruction if it matches their preconceived ideas, but they will despise anything that might jeopardize their pride system. In contrast, wise people will seek counsel and instruction, and be grateful for it. They represent the good soil into which the Bible encourages us to sow our seed.

### **2. Fools are addicted to foolish behavior**

**Proverbs 13:19** *"Desire realized is sweet to the soul, but it is an abomination to fools to depart from misorientation."* Another characteristic of foolish people is their misoriented behavior. The desires of the wise produce sweetness in the soul, but fools have compulsive cravings, which result in choices that sour and harm their souls. The compulsion behind these foolish choices is as forceful as religious fanaticism. It is not just abhorrent to fools if they are unable to satisfy their cravings, it actually assaults their self-worship system.

### 3. Fools are quick-tempered

**Proverbs 12:16** *"A fool's vexation is known at once, but a prudent man covers dishonor."* Fools have not developed *makrothumos*, or long-temperedness. They speak before they think, and they act rather than endure. When their pride is threatened, you can see at once that they are not interested in honoring you or God. They are untrustworthy and cannot cover for others.

### 4. The business of fools is deceit and illusion

**Proverbs 14:8** *"The wisdom of the prudent is to understand his own way, but the folly of fools is deception."* Fools are only interested in the illusions they create and not in real evidence; they deceive and are deceived. They are not interested in the truth about their lives or the lives of others, and they refuse to admit that they are the cause of their own problems. Wise people seek to understand why they do what they do. They make the effort to learn to do something different.

### 5. Fools will cause you harm

**Proverbs 13:20** *"Whoever walks with wise people becomes wise, but the companion of fools will suffer."* This is one of Nancy's life verses. Nancy has always looked for wise people to spend time with, but her Idol Self with its compulsive needs often drove her to become the companion of fools, and around them she suffered much more than was necessary for her growth.

The Book of Proverbs help us commit to reality, choosing to believe rather than judge what we see in ourselves and others. The wisdom of these proverbs teaches us how to look for good soil for sowing our seed. When you want to know what kind of people you are dealing with, speak your reality moderately, be honest, or offer a gift and see what happens. Are they foolish or wise? In what areas? You don't have to judge foolish people as evil or bad. You can simply believe that they want to live the way they do and then decide whether you want to be a part of that. Those who demonstrate the qualities of wise people are good investments. When you discover someone who has chosen the path to wisdom, pour your gifts into them and reap the rewards of *karis*.

Our prayer might go something like this:

*God of wisdom, show me how to be wise and show me who is wise, that we might walk together.*

### ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are very grateful for the created cycles that guide us to our healing. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You help us make friends with reality. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self, with the realities of our community, with the Creation, and with You, for the honor and glory of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.